



FEED THE FUTURE

The U.S. Government's Global Hunger & Food Security Initiative



Meeting the Moment

The Feed the Future Interagency Report
2024





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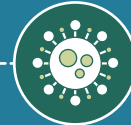
Feed the Future Timeline

2010

The United States led the global response to the crisis, committing over \$1 billion a year to establish a flagship global food security initiative.

2016

Congress enacted the U.S. commitment to global food security through Feed the Future into law through the Global Food Security Act (GFSA).



2008-2009

Sharply rising global food prices drove rising food insecurity, sparking panic and turmoil around the world.

2011-2012

The United States launched Feed the Future, a whole-of-U.S. government effort under the co-leadership of USAID and the Department of State. In its first year, Feed the Future responded to a drought and famine in the Horn of Africa.

2018

Congress reauthorized the GFSA – affirming continued bipartisan support to ending hunger through Feed the Future.

2020

Covid-19 shuttered markets and led to unprecedented shocks on global food systems. Feed the Future steps up to the plate and builds on a decade of progress to help accelerate recovery and strengthen long-term resilience while helping farmers and markets stay productive.



2022

Russia's unprovoked invasion of Ukraine placed even greater strain on the global food system after the conflict restricted exports from a key agricultural "breadbasket" and caused already high food prices to skyrocket. The United States doubled down on Feed the Future to stem rising food insecurity, providing more than \$14 billion in humanitarian and development assistance since the outbreak of the war in February 2022. In June, Feed the Future expanded to eight new target countries, bringing the total number of priority countries to 20. In December, Congress reauthorized the Global Food Security Act with strong bipartisan support.

2023

Thanks in part to U.S. investments under Feed the Future, global food systems largely recovered from combined global shocks, but regional crises related to extreme weather, conflict, and migration continue to plague food systems. In the Horn of Africa, for example, five consecutive failed rainy seasons and the most severe drought on record left 23 million people in the region suffering from a catastrophic lack of food.



2024 and onward

After a series of unprecedented global shocks to the food system underscored the urgency of building a more resilient global food system, Feed the Future is doubling down on its mandate to concentrate our resources strategically in agricultural bright spots amid the many hunger hotspots around the world.

Executive Summary



More than 15 years ago, the 2007–2008 global food price crisis triggered widespread panic and unrest and significantly increased the number of people experiencing hunger and food insecurity. In response, the international community mobilized, shifting attention and humanitarian resources to help those in acute need. The crisis also reemphasized the critical lesson that long-term investment in agriculture and food security is crucial to addressing the root causes of hunger and poverty. In answer to this imperative, the Feed the Future initiative emerged as the U.S. government’s flagship initiative to address the root causes of hunger, malnutrition, and extreme poverty. The initiative encompasses the expertise, resources, and talents of 12 U.S. government departments and agencies, along with partner governments, regional organizations, development partners, the private sector, civil society, research institutions, and U.S. universities. Looking back, we estimate that between 2010–2019, the prevalence of extreme poverty decreased by an average of 19 percent in the areas where Feed the Future focuses its efforts.

This decade has ushered in a new wave of global crises with profound impacts on poverty and hunger. From shocks including the COVID-19 pandemic, to Russia’s invasion of Ukraine, to the existential threat of climate change, we have once again seen limited food and fertilizer supplies and high prices create panic, disrupt trade, and heighten instability. In turn, the world has responded to record humanitarian needs. In 2023, in addition to providing lifesaving humanitarian aid, the United States has been able to mitigate a worsening global crisis by leveraging the innovation, expertise, and reach of Feed the Future.

In Fiscal Years (FYs) 2022 and 2023, Congress moved quickly to approve roughly \$1 billion in development assistance supplemental funds to mitigate against an unforeseeable global fertilizer shortage; increase investments in agricultural capacity, nutrition, and resilience; and cushion the impact of macroeconomic shocks on the most vulnerable households and communities. These funds were rapidly programmed into Feed the Future countries and activities to sustain farmers’ access to critical inputs and ensure their productivity; maintain market stability; protect access to safe, nutritious foods; and safeguard the well-being of children and other vulnerable populations through transfers and other safety nets, thereby potentially averting a larger catastrophe.

The United States also sounded the alarm to call others to action, proactively engaging countries to minimize trade disruptions, encouraging states to end the practice of fertilizer and food export bans, pushing international financial institutions to scale and surge their responses, working with fertilizer companies to maintain access for smallholder farmers, and calling on other development partners to similarly increase their humanitarian and development assistance to meet increased needs.



Despite our efforts, however, the world remains off track to achieving our goals to end poverty and hunger by 2030. The latest State of Food Security and Nutrition in the World (SOFI) report estimates that 28.9 percent of the world's population was moderately or severely food insecure in 2023.¹ Food systems must adapt to growing challenges to meet the needs of a growing population.

We know a tremendous amount about what works and what we need to do to meet today's challenges through Feed the Future. The initiative continues to produce impressive results by helping more than 6.2 million producers apply improved agricultural practices, supporting more than \$4.6 billion in annual sales from producers and firms, and leveraging \$677 million in private sector investment in FY 2023 alone.

This report is submitted pursuant to Subtitle G, Section 5588 of Public Law No: 117-263, James M. Inhofe National Defense Authorization Act for Fiscal Year 2023.² The report highlights the considerable work of Feed the Future across five areas critical to meeting today's challenges to ending poverty and hunger: strengthening the resilience of food systems, influencing evidence-based policy and institutional reform, driving increased private investment and financing, advancing gender equality and inclusion, and leveraging research and innovation. In support of, and through Feed the Future, the U.S. government has launched multiple programs and initiatives since 2020 that reinforce the initiative's core mandate: to build a more resilient, nutritious food system by concentrating investments in countries that we know are most in need and are best poised for regional agriculture-led growth. Looking ahead, we will have to make difficult trade-offs to address budget realities and continue to make progress in the face of complex challenges. Feed the Future must continue to build on its legacy of impact to help communities around the world strengthen their resilience and achieve a world where no one is hungry.



Introduction to the Initiative

History

In July 2009, at the G8 Summit in L'Aquila, Italy, the United States called on the world to increase investments in agriculture³ after decades of declining investments. The donor community responded by pledging a total of \$22 billion to promote global agricultural development. The United States committed \$3.5 billion over three years to a new global food security initiative. In 2010, the United States launched Feed the Future as a whole-of-U.S. government effort to sustainably reduce hunger and poverty.

Feed the Future's approach was codified into law in 2016 through the Global Food Security Act (GFSA), which Congress reauthorized in 2018 and again in 2022 with strong bipartisan support. Since Feed the Future's launch, the initiative has been a top priority of three White House Administrations and is a globally recognized symbol of the U.S. government's commitment toward achieving the Sustainable Development Goal of Zero Hunger.

The USAID Administrator leads the initiative, with deputy roles for development and diplomacy assigned to USAID and the U.S. Department of State (State Department), respectively. Feed the Future draws on the expertise and resources of 12 U.S. federal departments and agencies and partners with governments, nongovernmental organizations, private-sector businesses, universities, research institutions, and local communities and individuals to implement the initiative.

U.S. Global Food Security Strategy

The GFSA mandates the development of a U.S. Global Food Security Strategy (GFSS), which is implemented through Feed the Future programs. The goal and objectives of the GFSS 2022–2026 are highlighted below:

GFSS Goal:

Sustainably Reduce Global Hunger, Malnutrition, and Poverty

GFSS Objectives:



Inclusive and sustainable agriculture-led economic growth: Drive poverty reduction by increasing jobs and incomes through agriculture and food systems.⁴



Strengthened resilience among people, communities, countries, and systems: Help these groups mitigate risk and manage shocks and stresses without compromising their well-being.



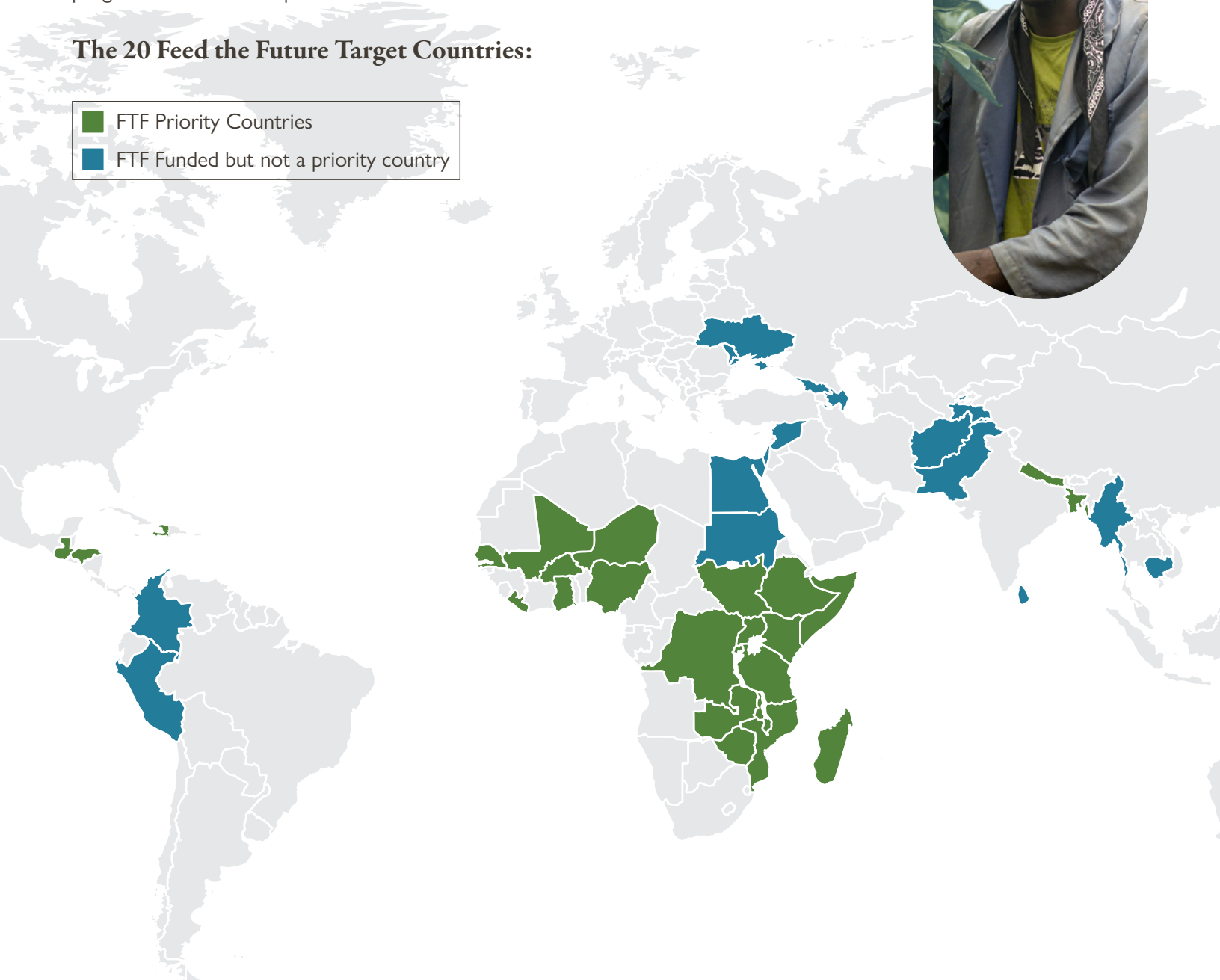
A well-nourished population, especially among women and children: Help everyone, especially women and children, have access to healthy diets and the chance to live healthy and productive lives.



Feed the Future meets these objectives through implementing country-specific plans that include a range of activities across four broad food system components: production, processing, distribution, and consumption.

With the aspiration to contribute to population-level impacts in Feed the Future's geographic areas of focus, the initiative concentrates its efforts in 20 target countries and four resilience countries, for a total of 24 priority countries. However, Feed the Future program resources are spread across more than 40 food-insecure countries worldwide.

The 20 Feed the Future Target Countries:



Impact



Feed the Future programming reached **33 million people** in FY 2023.

In FY 2023 alone, Feed the Future programming reached 33 million people. Looking back, we estimate that between 2010-2019, the prevalence of extreme poverty decreased by an average of 19 percent in the areas where Feed the Future focuses its efforts. This means that the estimated number of extreme poor in these areas declined by around 5.7 million people during this same period. Even in the face of immense challenges, Feed the Future has continued to deliver strong results.

As highlighted throughout this report, the U.S. government brings a wide range of expertise, political engagement, and tools to bear in the fight against poverty and hunger. Much of that work contributes to and extends well beyond Feed the Future target countries, especially through our global leadership in multilateral fora and policy agendas—which are of particular relevance in the face of global shocks such as the COVID-19 pandemic. The results and impact of Feed the Future are measured through a combination of population-based surveys conducted within subnational geographies in target countries as well as data from common indicators collected across a defined set of interagency programs. While the data are substantial in their own right, the numbers below underscore the role of Feed the Future as a powerful platform to give U.S. government leaders across the interagency a credible voice and influence to call on partners around the world to join us in more aggressively advancing the fight to end global hunger.

FY 2023 Feed the Future Results⁵



6.2 million producers applied improved agricultural practices on more than **4.5 million hectares** of cropland and cultivated pasture, including more than **2.8 million hectares** where climate adaptation or climate risk management practices or technologies were applied.



\$1.4 billion in agriculture-related financing was accessed, more than double the level in FY 2020, just four years ago.



The value of annual sales from producers and firms supported by Feed the Future reached an initiative record of **\$4.6 billion**. This includes more than **\$2.2 billion** in sales by smallholder producers.



Feed the Future leveraged **\$677 million** in private-sector investment, more than double the level of investment seen in FY 2020.



28.4 million children under five and **11.5 million** pregnant women were reached with nutrition-specific interventions.⁶

Feed the Future: A Unified Approach to Food Security and Food Systems Development

This collaborative ecosystem ensures that U.S. government efforts are aligned, responsive to local needs, and adaptable to emerging challenges, creating a sustainable approach to food systems development and enhancing food security worldwide.



Meeting the Moment



As of 2023, an estimated **733 million people** remain chronically hungry.

Current Context

This decade has tested global efforts to eradicate poverty and hunger like never before. Since 2020, the world has faced unprecedented crises that had wide-ranging, negative socioeconomic impacts and overtook much of our recent progress on these issues. High interest rates, the COVID-19 pandemic, and Russia's unjustified invasion of Ukraine further destabilized food systems amid an already challenging context of intensifying climate change and elevated levels of conflict, pushing prices of critical agricultural inputs and food out of reach for vulnerable countries, communities, and households. According to the 2024 State of Food Security and Nutrition in the World (SOFI) report, as of 2023, an estimated 733 million people remain chronically hungry.

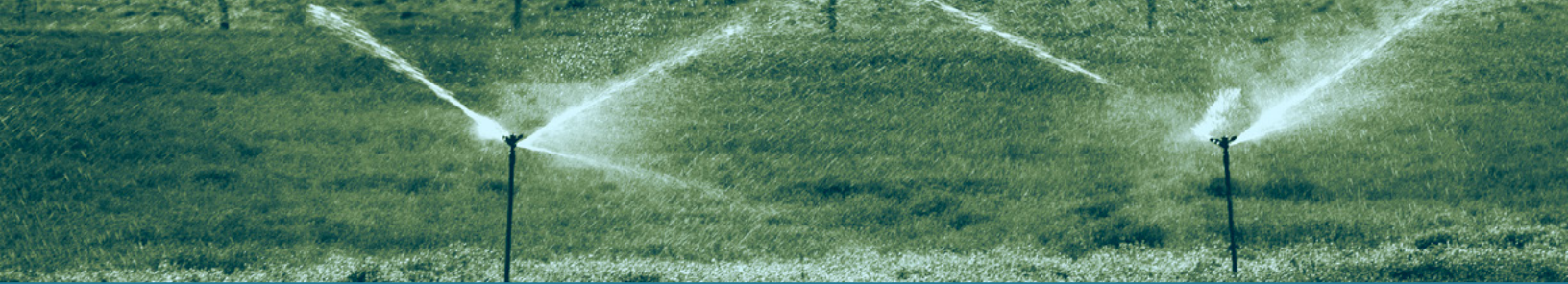
In response to recent crises, the United States has stepped up through Feed the Future with historic levels of humanitarian aid to meet acute food needs and increased development assistance. We have also leveraged our influence in a whole-of-government effort to keep food security at the forefront of the global agenda.

In 2021, amid the socioeconomic fall-out from the pandemic, the United States underscored the importance of strengthening food security and nutrition both at home and abroad, announcing during the United Nations (UN) Food Systems Summit a \$10 billion commitment to domestic and global food security over five years. The commitment included \$5 billion to support national food security through the U.S. Department of Agriculture (USDA), and \$5 billion to support global food security through Feed the Future, including a \$1 billion pledge from the U.S. International Development Finance Corporation (DFC).

Mitigating the Food Security Crisis

With Russia's invasion of Ukraine in early 2022 and following an export ban of phosphate by the People's Republic of China the preceding year, governments and markets across the globe quickly realized that tight grain stocks and high fuel prices would put additional pressure on food security. Worse, shortages of key inputs for fertilizer would also likely threaten future cropping seasons, with potentially devastating impacts for poorer countries highly dependent on imports.

As part of a Biden-Harris Administration whole-of-government plan to mitigate the emerging food security crisis, and through roughly \$1 billion in supplemental funding appropriated by Congress in FY 2022–2023, Feed the Future rapidly launched, redirected, or scaled activities to reach the countries and communities most at risk from the impacts of the war in Ukraine. The U.S. response centered around three key objectives: mitigate the global fertilizer shortage, increase investments in agricultural capacity and resilience, and cushion the macroeconomic shock and impact on those populations most vulnerable.



By leveraging private-sector partnerships, expanding or adapting bilateral activities, and joining multilateral efforts, Feed the Future has contributed to keeping farmers productive, markets functioning, and communities more resilient in the face of the myriad challenges.

Key objectives:

- | Mitigate global fertilizer shortage
- | Increase investments in agricultural capacity and resilience
- | Cushion macroeconomic shocks on vulnerable populations

Global Leadership

In addition to a swift and ongoing response through supplemental funding, the U.S. government spurred the global community into action. In April 2022, the U.S. Department of the Treasury (Treasury) called on international financial institutions (IFIs) to scale and surge a response to the crisis, which culminated in the *IFI Action Plan to Address Food Insecurity*. The plan outlined steps that IFIs would take to scale up their financing, tools, technical assistance, and policy engagement to address the rising food insecurity and agriculture needs that the crisis exacerbated.

In May 2022, the State Department leveraged the U.S. presidency of the UN Security Council to issue a call to action that included a roadmap of seven urgent actions for countries to take to stem the food security crisis. More than 100 countries signed the roadmap. During the U.S.-Africa Leaders Summit in December 2022, the United States and the African Union (AU) established a Joint Strategic Partnership on Food Security to work together with our African partners to build more resilient food systems, diversify supply chains, and increase agricultural production capacity on the African continent. Strong U.S. leadership on food security in the Group of Seven (G7), Group of Twenty (G20), UN General Assembly, and Conference of the Parties (COP), as well as swift action from Congress to increase funding to Feed the Future, has underscored America's commitment to eradicating hunger and poverty and pushed public- and private-sector partners alike to follow suit.



Feed the Future rapidly launched, redirected, or scaled activities with roughly **\$1 billion in supplemental funding** appropriated by Congress in FY 2022–2023.



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Plantville

USAID
FROM THE AMERICAN PEOPLE

Fit for Purpose

While food and fertilizer prices have largely stabilized at a global level, affordability remains a challenge, conflict and climate change are constant threats, and hunger and poverty remain unacceptably high. Though we have lost ground to the sheer magnitude of recent shocks, the effects of our work prove that through Feed the Future we know what to do, we can adapt to meet new challenges, and we can make real progress. The expertise and partnerships of the Feed the Future interagency come together to meet the objectives of the GFSS in five critical, priority areas: strengthening the resilience of food systems; influencing evidence-based policy and institutional reform; driving increased private investment and financing; advancing gender equality and inclusion; and leveraging research and innovation. Each of the following sections describes major efforts of the initiative over the past several years and highlights examples from across the Feed the Future interagency.



1. Strengthening the Resilience of Food Systems

Environmental degradation, climate change, and conflict and fragility in many Feed the Future countries are affecting our ability to grow food while the number of people to feed increases. More than three billion people live in areas highly vulnerable to climate change where increasing extreme weather makes it harder for them to access the food and water they need to survive.⁷ This increasing pressure on natural resources coupled with greater weather variability and more frequent climatic shocks is intensifying competition over those resources and leading to greater conflict. People, communities, and systems also lack adequate, effective risk-management approaches that can be employed to help cope with shocks and stresses while avoiding an erosion of productive assets or development gains.



Inter-American Foundation (IAF) Facilitates Community-Led Watershed Management in Honduras

Since 2021, the IAF has invested \$6.2 million in 27 local civil-society organizations promoting food security in Honduras. One of these organizations, Asociación para el Manejo Integrado de Cuencas de La Paz y Comayagua, strengthened management of watershed councils and water board associations that protect the water resources of the Jilguero Mountain Reserve in western Honduras. With IAF funding for training, technical assistance, and seed capital, the association's members now effectively monitor water quality, conduct timely maintenance of water systems, map their watersheds for land-use and risk management, and resolve emerging land use conflicts. The organizations have garnered \$60,000 in new public-sector commitments and mobilized around 3,000 community members to mark boundaries, fence water-source areas, organize squadrons to fight and prevent forest fires, and reforest over 7,000 acres. Together, these community organizations manage the long-term water supply for almost 40,000 people during crises and natural disasters.



Peace Corps Facilitates Growth of Resilient Home Gardens

Feed the Future Resilience Efforts

The certainty that these challenges will continue, or worsen, explains why building resilience—helping people, communities, and countries protect and improve their well-being in the face of accelerating shocks and stresses—is a GFSS objective and was a critical component of the U.S. government’s near-term plan to address the food security crisis in the wake of Russia’s aggression in Ukraine. Even more importantly, evidence shows that households and communities within Feed the Future’s geographic areas have been more resilient through the past several years of shocks than those in uncovered geographic areas.

The Feed the Future Resilience in the Sahel Enhanced (RISE I) program successfully integrated long-term livelihood, governance, and nutrition activities with existing humanitarian and food security assistance to support an estimated 1.9 million vulnerable people. The RISE I program focused its efforts in three areas: increased and sustainable economic well-being, strengthened institutions and governance, and improved health and nutrition. A recent impact evaluation of RISE 1 found that households benefiting from the program were significantly more food secure than other households. As a result, when shocks occurred, affected households were able to avoid negative coping strategies—such as holding distress sales of productive assets or significantly reducing food consumption—and instead could continue tending livestock and growing crops. Crucially, the RISE I program directly prevented one in five extremely vulnerable individuals from experiencing severe food insecurity. These impacts on food security are even more impressive given that the COVID-19 pandemic limited implementation during the activity’s final years. These results, in concert with findings from the Pastoralist Areas Resilience Improvement through Market Expansion Ethiopia and the Partnership for Resilience and Economic Growth (PREG II) Kenya⁸ impact evaluations, reflect a growing evidence base for USAID’s approach to strengthening resilience through multi-sectoral programming that links humanitarian, development, and peace (HDP) assistance. This evidence has informed USAID’s updated Resilience Policy,⁹ released in 2024, to guide resilience efforts over the coming decade.

In 2023, the Peace Corps provided technical assistance to improve food security and nutrition at the household level in nearly 30 countries, including 14 Feed the Future target countries. Nearly 100 Peace Corps Volunteers assisted smallholder farming households in establishing resilient home gardens, which were specifically designed to withstand climate challenges. Resilient home gardens are strategically located near homes for easy management and protection, featuring a diverse array of local vegetables, legumes, root crops, and perennial shrubs. Integrated multipurpose trees provide natural fencing, protection from the elements, improved soil fertility, and additional household benefits such as fruits, fodder, fuel, and medicinal resources. By diversifying crops, these climate-resilient gardens ensure year-round availability of nutrient-rich foods and create an additional income source for households.



Accelerated Innovation Delivery Initiative (AID-I) Rapidly Helps Farmers in Fertilizer Crisis

Russia's invasion of Ukraine threatened future crop production in many Feed the Future countries by causing shortages and higher prices of agricultural inputs. Using supplemental funding, USAID, in collaboration with the State Department, launched the AID-I to rapidly mobilize existing, on-the-ground networks to support African farmers in six affected countries. AID-I uses market-driven approaches to reach farmers with the improved seeds, fertilizer, and practical information they need to maximize their future harvests while simultaneously supporting local businesses to sustain support over time. To date, AID-I reached two million farmers with critical support.



Hunger and the Climate Crisis

One study estimates that climate change has reduced global agricultural total factor productivity by about 21 percent since 1961, a slowdown that is equivalent to losing the last seven years of productivity growth.¹⁰ Yet, food demand is expected to increase 25 percent by 2050—and by more than 50 percent in Sub-Saharan Africa.¹¹

The updated GFSS reflects this deepening challenge and articulates the need for Feed the Future to integrate climate adaptation more intentionally into strategies and programs. The initiative is expanding efforts to adapt a greater variety of crops and livestock to climate change and scaling support to farmers to adopt climate-smart practices and technologies. In particular, the Feed the Future interagency has spearheaded two main efforts related to climate change: the Vision for Adapted Crops and Soils (VACS) and the Agricultural Innovation Mission (AIM) for Climate.

Agricultural Innovation Mission (AIM) for Climate

In 2021, the United States and the United Arab Emirates created the AIM for Climate¹² to drive ambitious investment in innovation for climate-smart agriculture and food systems that will have cascading benefits. AIM for Climate is led by USDA in close collaboration with the State Department, USAID, and others across the interagency.

Since the launch of the five-year initiative, AIM for Climate has formed a historic coalition with 55 countries, including 13 Feed the Future countries and more than 600 partners, to mobilize an estimated \$17 billion from the public and private sectors in climate-smart investments. As part of the U.S. commitment to AIM for Climate, in 2021, Feed the Future committed \$215 million for related research by the Consultative Group on International Agricultural Research (CGIAR),¹³ the international agricultural research consortium, in low- and middle-income countries. At COP28 in 2023, USAID announced an additional \$100 million investment in CGIAR, subject to availability of funds, over the next two years. This investment further enables CGIAR to reach smallholder farmers with climate-smart innovations and contributes to the implementation of VACS.



Food demand is expected to increase **25 percent by 2050**—and by more than 50 percent in Sub-Saharan Africa.



AIM for Climate has also spurred more than 78 private-sector-led Innovation Sprints. In 2023, USAID, in cooperation with Canada and Honduras, launched a worldwide call to action for Innovation Sprints to tackle gender equality and women's empowerment in agri-food systems, resulting in more than \$40 million of commitments. USAID, mostly through Feed the Future programming, is directly partnering on seven Innovation Sprints and contributing to many more through partners that support smallholder farmer challenges related to sustainable intensification (increasing crop and livestock productivity while reducing inputs per hectare planted or meat and milk produced), genetic improvements, improved farm management, and gender and youth.

Vision for Adapted Crops and Soils (VACS)

In partnership with the African Union (AU) and the Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations (FAO), the State Department launched the Vision for Adapted Crops and Soils (VACS) initiative as part of the Feed the Future program. Under the auspices of VACS, efforts have focused on building resilient food systems by investing in diverse, nutritious, and climate-adapted crops grown in healthy soils. Collaborations with the International Fund for Agricultural Development (IFAD), FAO, and CGIAR have established enduring mechanisms for donors to contribute to VACS activities, including the flagship IFAD VACS fund. More than \$60 million has been raised from six governments, with additional commitments under discussion.

Implementation, led by IFAD, FAO, CGIAR, and USAID, is underway for \$109 million of the \$150 million committed by the United States. With these funds, programs have been launched to expand farmer access to "opportunity crop" seeds, increase investments in the improvement of such crops, enhance the quantity and utility of soil information available to farmers, improve fertilizer efficiency and crop productivity, and facilitate the adoption of better soil health practices. VACS has also served to reaffirm U.S. commitment and leadership in addressing global food insecurity. Efforts are being made to work with major institutions to integrate VACS objectives into their strategic plans and programs. There is progress in securing financial and policy commitments to VACS through the G7.

A VACS Champions program has been created, comprising 17 members, with more under discussion, to recognize the activities of companies and nonprofits that align with VACS objectives. Additionally, a Community of Practice has been launched, engaging over 1,000 active participants. More than 500 individuals, primarily practitioners in Africa, have volunteered to participate in VACS working groups to advance its goals.



2. Influencing Evidence-Based Policy and Institutional Reform

Ineffective, unsustainable policies and weak institutions can inhibit progress on hunger and poverty goals and exacerbate a looming crisis. At the height of the crisis of 2008, for example, an estimated 19 percent of the world's food supply was subject to trade

Strengthening Data-Driven Decision-Making Through Feed the Future

Russia's invasion of Ukraine reduced the quantity of grain, fertilizer, and fuel traded on global markets and sent prices soaring. Meanwhile, governments, traders, and other stakeholders struggled to estimate how changing stock levels and rising prices would affect poverty, hunger, and malnutrition. The crisis underscored the importance of Feed the Future-backed platforms including the Agricultural Management Information Systems (AMIS). Launched as a part of the G20, AMIS seeks to strengthen collaboration and dialogue among the main producing, exporting, and importing countries of the targeted crops. AMIS offers much-needed transparency on key commodities that can help to tamp down price volatility rooted in conjecture while also providing a common set of data on which policymakers can undertake collective dialogue and action.

Feed the Future also works to strengthen data systems in low-and middle-income countries, including the 50x2030 initiative, a tri-party initiative of the World Bank, FAO, and IFAD. The initiative works to fill agricultural data gaps and promote evidence-informed decision-making by building the capacity of low-and middle-income countries to conduct high-quality, reliable agricultural surveys. The improved availability of high-quality, local data will contribute to better decision-making, reduce U.S. government expenditures on data collection, and support improved capacity to manage shocks such as Russia's invasion of Ukraine.

restrictions,¹⁴ which further drove up food prices and limited access to sufficient food for vulnerable communities and countries. The pandemic, war in Ukraine, and most recently El Niño have given rise to a new wave of unjustified restrictions on trade that have, once again, made a bad situation even more challenging.

Feed the Future promotes evidence-driven and transparent policy agendas, capable and accountable institutions, and adequate public and private resources as critical components to ending hunger. During this most recent crisis—and contrary to 2008—we leveraged our local and regional Feed the Future partners to promote more informed country decision-making. As one example, we worked with AGRA, a pan-African agricultural organization, to establish a “war room” to share food security analysis and other critical information with African leaders and promote discussion and informed decisions.

The United States also serves as a leader in multilateral fora to influence policy reform at the continental or global levels. Although country-level policy agendas are contextually driven, the Feed the Future interagency has coalesced around a common agenda of top policy priorities and elevated that agenda through wide-ranging multilateral engagement. Several of the common themes that have emerged as critical to the current landscape include maintaining free and fair trade and advancing regulatory alignment; coordinating national climate and agriculture strategies and commitments to protect both people and the planet; advancing reforms to facilitate private-sector investment; and revamping costly and poorly targeted subsidy programs that are unsustainable. With food security featured in almost every global dialogue over the past four years, including two Food Systems Summits and the Africa Fertilizer and Soil Health Summit, the United States has leveraged numerous opportunities to influence stakeholders and amplify U.S. policy priorities.

Africa Fertilizer and Soil Health Summit

Over the last ten years, growth in global consumption of fertilizer has remained below 2 percent per year;



USAID and USDA Support Good Regulatory Practices in Sanitary and Phytosanitary (SPS) to Improve Food Safety, Trade, and Investment

during this period, fertilizer consumption in Africa has consistently maintained an annual growth rate of approximately 8 percent, and average fertilizer use in Sub-Saharan Africa increased to 18 kilograms in 2021 alone.¹⁵

In May 2024, more than 1,500 people gathered in Nairobi, Kenya, for the second Africa Fertilizer and Soil Health Summit to develop strategies for enhancing African food security through better management of key inputs and natural resources. There, Feed the Future leaders delivered opening and closing statements expressing U.S. support for African-led agricultural growth, emphasizing the enormous potential that African farmers and agribusinesses hold to feed the continent and the world.

In the lead-up to the summit, U.S. technical experts supported AU counterparts in developing a ten-year *Fertilizer and Soil Health Action Plan* and the *Soil Initiative for Africa Framework* as key guiding documents to harness multi-stakeholder partnerships and investments to drive policies, finance, research and development, markets, and capacity building for fertilizer and sustainable soil health management in Africa. These documents were endorsed by the AU and member states supporting implementation.

The 2024 summit culminated in the *Nairobi Declaration*, which reflects the emerging consensus that mineral fertilizers are necessary but insufficient to reverse land degradation and sustainably increase productivity of Africa's soils. The summit's theme, "Listening to the land," highlighted the urgent need to scale Integrated Soil Fertility Management practices alongside more efficient and effective fertilizer use to scale sustainable and productive agriculture on the continent. This features centrally in the Nairobi Declaration.

The United States also led an effort to rally donors in support of a joint development partner statement that was ultimately signed by 14 partners and expresses intentions to support the *Fertilizer and Soil Health Action Plan* and post-summit implementation. USAID commitments include \$40 million to expand a more efficient and cost-effective approach to fertilizer use called Space to Place.

Under the Food Safety for Food Security (FS4FS) partnership, USAID and USDA have launched an activity to help regulators in GFSS priority countries pursue SPS reforms through the adoption of good regulatory practices. Regulatory process inefficiency has a cost; by adopting more transparent rulemaking, countries could reduce SPS costs by an estimated average of 14.3 percent, translating to lower food costs and improved access. USDA and USAID help regulators develop regulations that are simpler, safer, and smarter through more inclusive stakeholder consultations, transparent procedures, and evidence-based decision making. This new partnership will sustain and expand efforts to help regulators identify key gaps and offer a practical set of tools to help them adopt improved regulatory practices. As one example, USAID assistance to the Honduran customs and phytosanitary agencies—including the introduction of a new paperless system and joint inspections of agricultural products at the country's largest port (Puerto Cortés)—cut processing times in half and has led to over \$15 million in annual cost savings. Seeing the dividends, the Honduras Customs Administration has committed to implement the new procedures for land, sea, and air borders.

Supporting National and Regional Policy Reform

Feed the Future promotes country ownership by supporting national policy reform implementation and collaborating with country governments to set policy and funding priorities for food security and nutrition. Alignment of policy approaches across countries is also critical in terms of supporting free and fair trade and expanding markets, including for U.S. commodities. We work with regional economic communities to align standards and build regulatory capacity to facilitate the flow of agricultural goods and services across borders.

Millennium Challenge Corporation (MCC) Compacts Drive Policy and Institutional Reform through Feed the Future

The \$442 million MCC Compact in Niger, implemented between 2018 and 2024, shepherded in significant agricultural policy and institutional reforms alongside notable infrastructure investments. MCC's prominent contributions include expanding market-access roads by over 300 kilometers, improving irrigation across 2,450 hectares, establishing 16 livestock markets, vaccinating an estimated 30 million animals, and developing over 70,000 hectares of pasture land. Additionally, MCC's Fertilizer Sector Reform Project (PARSEN) mandated legislative changes¹⁶ as a prerequisite for leveraging the full scope of MCC's Compact investment. These reform efforts in Niger's fertilizer sector are poised to have lasting impact. Niger was previously one of the least-fertilized countries globally, and MCC facilitated a governmental decree to liberalize the fertilizer sector, thus abolishing barriers to competition formerly imposed by parastatals.

The Compact also assisted in establishing regulatory bodies; funded a transparent e-voucher subsidy program benefiting more than 13,000 vulnerable families; and ultimately helped Niger's private sector triple fertilizer imports to over 90,000 metric tons. As Niger navigates its political future, effective governance and policy continuity will be vital to ensure farmers' access to essential market inputs.

MCC's model of large, five-year interventions can act as an inflection point for the sectors that are selected as pivotal to grow partner countries' economies and reduce poverty. In the recent partnerships with Mozambique and Zambia—expected to begin activities in 2025 and 2026, respectively—the large injection of investment in infrastructure and financing has created additional space to introduce policy and institutional reforms that are necessary for sectoral transformation and growth.¹⁷

In Mozambique, MCC is building on a foundation laid by USAID's Supporting the Policy Enabling Environment for Development program, which provides fiscal policy recommendations aimed at increasing private-sector participation and investment. As part of the \$500 million Connectivity and Coastal Resilience Compact signed in 2023, the Government of Mozambique will usher in the *Pacote de reformas da fiscalidade ao investimento agrícola* (PREFIA activity). PREFIA makes key alignments in fiscal and taxation policies to attract more private investment and increase rural incomes by





Since 2015, USDA has funded **\$52 million** in school feeding assistance in Rwanda.

making it easier and more efficient to procure commodities from smallholder farmers. With more certainty on the structure of taxation and incentives, rural investors will also be incentivized through MCC's results-based financing project to help expand smallholder production.

MCC's \$458 million Compact with Zambia,¹⁸ aims to strengthen key public sector institutions' abilities to implement an improved policy framework to boost private participation in the agriculture and agro-processing sectors. By using the conditions precedent for the funding mechanism, the Government of Zambia is committing to enact these reforms or rescind the funds dedicated to the agricultural policy reform project funding. If the reforms are enacted, the project expects to help the Ministry of Agriculture and the Food Reserve Agency implement the new legal framework, support ancillary market institutions that will contribute to a favorable market ecosystem, and strengthen the fledgling commodity exchange and availability of market information.

From Research to Policy: USAID's Partnerships Safeguard Nepal's Food Supply

In April 2024, the Government of Nepal issued its first-ever Food Safety Act, which was the result of almost a decade of USAID engagement to strengthen food safety systems. The work started in 2016 with an effort to carry out an assessment of mycotoxin in Feed the Future-supported value chains in Nepal. The study was completed and disseminated in 2019 thanks to the partnership between two Feed the Future Innovation Labs (ILs), Mars Inc. and USAID, as well as multiple local stakeholders including members of the Government of Nepal's planning committee.

In 2020, COVID-19 slightly derailed the efforts, but renewed engagement in 2022 by the Feed the Future ILs for Food Safety and Food Systems for Nutrition in Nepal revived these efforts. After the Food Safety Act was passed, the Ministry of Agriculture and Livestock Development and the Department of Food Technology and Quality Control requested to partner with both ILs to support the Government of Nepal in translating the act into policies and regulations to strengthen food safety systems.

USDA Works to Ensure School-Feeding Assistance Thrives in Rwanda

Since 2015, USDA has funded \$52 million in school feeding assistance in Rwanda. Under the current \$25 million, five-year project, the McGovern-Dole International Food for Education and Child Nutrition Program has been successful in supporting the development of the Government of Rwanda's Home-Grown School Feeding Programme (NSFP). In September 2023, 108 schools formerly supported by McGovern-Dole were successfully integrated into the NSFP. To prepare the schools and government entities for the transition, the World Food Programme (WFP) collaborated with Rwandan stakeholders—including the Ministry of Education, districts, and schools—to develop a transition strategy with clear timelines, key milestones, roles and responsibilities, and post-handover support, and a work plan to ensure any gains in the NSFP are not

USDA's Private-Sector Partnerships Boost Productivity in Coffee and Cacao

USDA's Food for Progress—funded Maximizing Opportunities in Coffee and Cacao in the Americas (MOCCA) is transforming the livelihoods of more than 130,000 coffee and cacao farmers across six countries: El Salvador, Guatemala, Honduras, Nicaragua, Ecuador, and Peru. By enhancing productivity and sales, MOCCA aims to boost farmer incomes through comprehensive training, improved access to inputs, affordable financing, and higher-value trading models. Access to high-quality training services has significantly increased through combined investments totaling \$8.3 million from national market systems, international corporations, and USDA. As a result, coffee productivity has risen by 45 percent and cacao productivity by 24 percent.

MOCCA collaborates with over 50 market-system actors, including exporters, producer organizations, lenders, and government extension programs. These partners have collectively invested over \$5.5 million to expand and improve training and technical assistance. Additionally, corporate partners have contributed \$2.8 million to support training, access to improved planting materials, and finance. A regional lender working group also supports the activity and has successfully expanded loan accessibility for smallholder farmers.

affected by the transition. This consultative process and continual discussions with district officials and schools helped to ensure all 108 schools were planned for in the government budget and prepared for the transition.



3. Driving Increased Private Investment and Financing

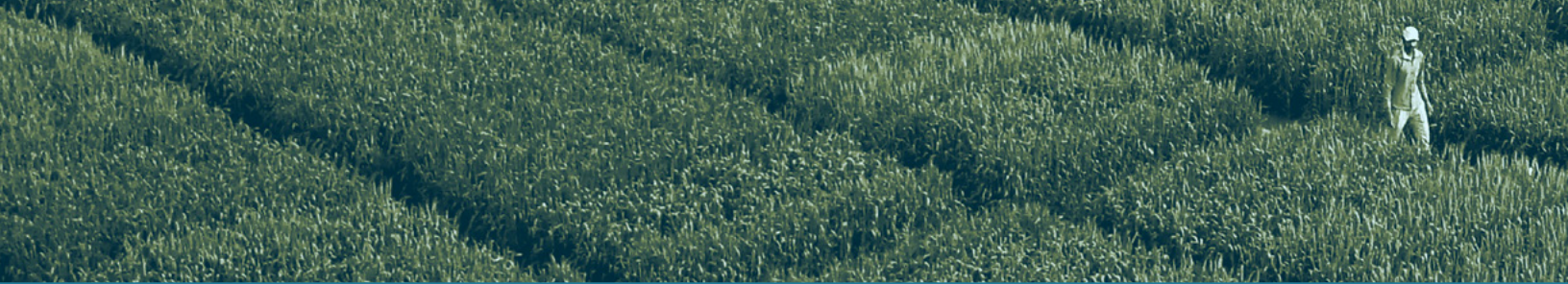
Over the lifespan of the initiative, Feed the Future has leveraged an estimated \$4 billion in private-sector investment and helped participants access \$7.6 billion in agriculture-related financing to help fight hunger, poverty, and malnutrition. Through private-sector partnerships, we facilitate complementary investments in infrastructure (e.g., warehouses, factories, irrigation), services, and improved technologies, all of which add value to agricultural economies and support job growth. In total, producers and firms supported by Feed the Future have reported more than \$31 billion in sales of agricultural products and services since the initiative began.

While Feed the Future engages many U.S. and multinational companies, we also support thousands of small and medium agri-businesses (agri-SMEs) to drive their expansion. Agri-SMEs, as Africa's largest employer and economic engine, are key to fighting hunger. They create jobs and support 95 percent of smallholder farmers with critical tools and services to increase productivity and profitability¹⁹—delivering seeds and fertilizer; providing training; purchasing food from farmers; and transporting, storing, and processing food.

USAID Launches the Financing for Agricultural Small-and-Medium Enterprises in Africa (FASA) Fund

Despite the importance of agri-SMEs, three out of four cannot access traditional bank loans but are too large to qualify for microfinance loans. This creates an estimated \$100 billion gap in unmet demand for financing that is critical to feeding the future.²⁰

At the 2023 UN General Assembly, USAID and Government of Norway announced the Financing for



In 2021, an estimated **13.2 percent of food** was lost globally after harvest on farm, transport, storage, wholesale, and processing.

Agricultural Small-and-Medium Enterprises in Africa (FASA) Fund to spur investment in Africa's agricultural growth. With an initial commitment of \$35 million each from USAID and the Government of Norway, the fund aims to reach \$200 million through additional donor contributions that will catalyze hundreds of millions more in commercial financing by reducing investment risk. The FASA Fund has the potential to support 500 agri-SMEs, 1.5 million smallholder farmers, and nearly 60,000 private-sector jobs—ultimately benefiting nearly 7.5 million people.

Limited access to finance is a major constraint to food systems transformation, and de-risking financing to farmers and companies is a top Feed the Future priority. Like the FASA Fund, other Feed the Future efforts are utilizing new tools to de-risk investments in agriculture and food systems, which mobilizes limited development funding even further.

DFC Transactions Facilitate Additional Financing for Food Systems

In 2022, the DFC played a pivotal role in addressing the global fertilizer crisis. When African agro-dealers faced a sharp reduction in the amount of fertilizer they could access on credit and then provide to farmers, the DFC provided a \$10 million second-loss guarantee²¹ to the African Fertilizer and Agribusiness Partnership (AFAP). This financial arrangement sat above a \$2 million funded first-loss reserve provided by The Bill & Melinda Gates Foundation and USAID and allowed AFAP to guarantee agro-dealers 50 percent of \$24 million of sales from suppliers. This innovative financing is empowering AFAP to radically expand its trade credit guarantee program, reducing the risk for suppliers and encouraging them to extend more credit to small and medium agribusinesses. Every 60–90 days, agro-dealers can return to AFAP for another \$24 million cycle. The project is anticipated to enable \$360 million of fertilizer sales over three years from February 2024 to June 2027, which will contribute to improving agricultural yields and boosting farmers' incomes in Ghana, Zambia, and Kenya. By combining a range of stakeholders including DFC, AFAP, USAID, and the Gates Foundation, AFAP contributes directly to sustainable food systems and the economic empowerment of smallholder farmers across the region while also presenting a scalable model for enhancing agricultural input supply chains in Sub-Saharan Africa.

According to the FAO, in 2021, an estimated 13.2 percent of food was lost globally after harvest on farm, transport, storage, wholesale, and processing.²² In 2023, DFC committed two loans totaling nearly \$20 million to enable Ifria Cold Chain Development Company to construct the first of a series of cold-chain warehouse facilities across North and West Africa, starting in Morocco and Senegal. Cold-chain systems are highly underdeveloped or non-existent throughout much of the developing world, especially in Africa. The facilities will increase the local availability of temperature-controlled, large-scale cold-chain storage for food and pharmaceutical products. These two facilities in Morocco and Senegal are expected to reduce food losses by 35,700 metric tons per year and generate 1.44 gigawatts of renewable energy per year. DFC is enabling new developers to make projects viable for financing; a DFC technical assistance grant of \$343,000 also helped fund Ifria's early-stage assessments of incorporating solar power and energy-efficiency measures



into the cold-chain facilities. The grant also helped fund an analysis of integrating storage of agricultural and pharmaceutical products, and additional environmental and social impact assessments.

Global Agriculture and Food Security Program (GAFSP)

GAFSP is a multilateral financing mechanism hosted within the World Bank Group. The program, which the U.S. government co-chairs, launched by the G20 in the wake of the 2008 food price crisis, provides grants to countries and producer organizations, as well as concessional loans and blended-finance solutions to support agribusinesses' activities along the food value chain. Through this work, GAFSP complements and reinforces other multilateral and bilateral initiatives addressing food insecurity, including Feed the Future.

In 2023, GAFSP committed approximately \$270 million in grant funding for 18 low-income countries to help build food systems resilience and support vulnerable communities. GAFSP also deployed \$34 million to 15 producer organization-led projects in 13 low-income countries. Since inception, GAFSP has held seven calls for proposals that have committed nearly \$2.4 billion across more than 40 countries through governments, the private sector, and producer organizations, working with and through IFIs.

To date, GAFSP projects have supported more than 16.6 million rural community members, including nearly 7 million women. Additionally, the portfolio is an overall net reducer of greenhouse gasses (GHGs), as all public-sector projects include adaptation or mitigation co-benefits which support critical agricultural interventions that boost farmers' climate resilience.

GAFSP also launched a consultation on the design of its new Business Investment Financing Track (BIFT). Through the BIFT, GAFSP aims to promote coordination between the public and private sectors to scale up blended concessional finance for investments in agriculture and food and nutrition security in low-income countries.

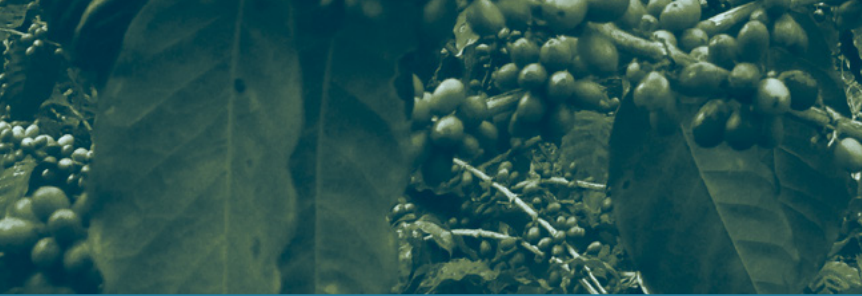


Achieving gender parity in food systems could potentially boost global gross domestic product by nearly **\$1 trillion** and significantly reduce food insecurity for up to **45 million people**.



4. Advancing Gender Equality and Inclusion

Women, who make up nearly half of the agricultural workforce in low-income countries, are disproportionately affected by food insecurity but are central to solving global hunger.²³ FAO estimates that achieving gender parity in food systems could potentially boost global gross domestic product by nearly \$1 trillion and significantly reduce food insecurity for up to 45 million people.²⁴ While investing in women has been, and remains, a core Feed the Future priority, global progress in improving women's access to finance, digital technology, land, inputs, information, and other services has lagged.²⁵ As a result, women-owned farms are still on average 24 percent less productive than their male-owned counterparts, a figure that has remained unchanged over the last decade.²⁶ Recognizing these challenges, Feed the Future is strategically increasing investments in



Lenca Women of Honduras Use Inter-American Foundation (IAF) Grant to Help Their Communities Thrive

research and programming aimed at advancing gender equality within agrifood systems.

Acknowledging the insufficient progress to date, Feed the Future is committed to investing in the evidence base to better understand the most effective and cost-efficient interventions to advance gender equality and inclusion.

USAID's Generating Resilience and Opportunities for Women (GROW)

Launched in April 2023 by USAID, the Generating Resilience and Opportunities for Women (GROW) commitment aims to catalyze action to tackle the persistent inequalities women face in food and water systems while unlocking economic opportunities. In FY 2023, GROW committed to investing approximately \$335 million—\$252 million of which is invested through Feed the Future to deepen and scale programming to reach, benefit, and empower more women. USAID exceeded this commitment by \$114 million, for a total of \$449 million in the fiscal year, reinforcing USAID's role and dedication to advancing gender equality and women's empowerment in the agricultural sector, which lifts whole economies.²⁷

Through GROW, USAID's Feed the Future activities work with country governments, implementing partners, and local communities to increase on-farm productivity and resilience among women farmers. The commitment also supports their full participation in diversified, climate-resilient economic opportunities beyond agriculture as well as tackles discriminatory social norms, policies, and practices that perpetuate gender inequities. Positioning women's diets is a key component of strengthening their resilience within the food system. Key areas of focus include improving access to agricultural technologies, fostering innovation, enhancing financial inclusion, and expanding market access.

In the Intibucá region of Honduras, more than a quarter of residents currently face crisis levels of food insecurity, according to the Integrated Food Security Phase Classification. A grassroots association of indigenous women farmers, however, is working to reduce hunger and malnutrition and improving life for themselves, their families, and their communities.

Through an IAF grant, the Lenca women of the *Asociación de Mujeres Intibucanas Renovadas* (AMIR) have improved agricultural production and farmer incomes in their area, resulting in better food security and less malnutrition. AMIR consists of 650 Lenca women operating 36 grassroots groups in the municipalities of Intibucá and San Francisco de Opalaca. These women farmers grow potatoes, corn, beans, vegetables, and fruit, and AMIR trains its members on sustainable farming methods to enrich the soil and improve farm yields. AMIR also supports farmers and producers in processing crops and marketing items to sell locally.

The IAF grant has allowed AMIR to create a savings and credit fund, with minimum requirements, to assist its members with farming costs. Overall, about 6,400 people in the area have benefitted from the IAF grant and more than 500 farmers have improved their yields through sustainable production techniques and use of grain dryers. Additionally, more than 850 participants have improved their diets by consuming a more diverse range of vegetables from 100 kitchen gardens. These efforts have helped participants increase their access to meat and dairy products and better understand nutrition to create healthier meals.





USDA's McGovern-Dole Project Supports the Nutrition of Women and Children in Malawi

Nascent Solutions, with funding from USDA, has been implementing the McGovern-Dole International Food for Education and Child Nutrition Project in 106 schools in six districts of Malawi, providing hot meals to 78,000 learners daily since 2019. The McGovern-Dole program works through the health centers in Malawi to provide 5,000 pregnant and lactating women and more than 4,000 children under five in care groups who are malnourished with rations of supercereal (CSB+). The health centers teach mothers how to prepare the CSB+ and nourish their children, then provides home visits to ensure that the children are improving. Along with supporting school-age children through a daily school meal, Nascent grows food crops for home consumption and school feeding. Additionally, women farmers engage in small-scale income-generating activities, such as poultry keeping.



5. Leveraging Research and Innovation

Feed the Future is putting game-changing research and technology into the hands of farmers to strengthen food systems—and ultimately reduce hunger, poverty, and malnutrition. Specifically, Feed the Future is investing in climate-smart, higher-yielding seed and livestock varieties, developing digital solutions to better inform and equip farmers and other market actors, and scaling access to and uptake of low-cost, efficient technologies. The United States is an agricultural powerhouse, and leveraging our domestic capabilities, scientific rigor, and expertise is a win-win proposition for developing agricultural economies as well as for our farmers, universities, and companies here at home.

Global Food Security Research Strategy: Leveraging Research and Innovation

Since Feed the Future's inception in 2010, the initiative has featured a strong focus on science and technology. Research under Feed the Future is not only about solving challenges to agricultural production, but also advances objectives to empower women, reduce micronutrient deficiency, increase the affordability of nutritious foods—particularly for the three billion people for whom a healthy diet remains out of reach—and improve public policy and public-sector investments in agriculture and food security. Taken together, research-derived innovations help reduce extreme poverty across by increasing incomes through lower real prices for main staples as well as targeting key nutritious foods (e.g., vegetables, dairy, fish, poultry, eggs, and livestock) that put a healthy diet within reach of low-income populations, all while sustainably stewarding natural resources.

The Global Food Security Act mandates that research under the act consider other federally funded research that is relevant to global food security. USAID and USDA





“Now we can produce the food we eat, sell, save, pay our children’s school fees, and help the community,” Habibu said. Her annual maize production skyrocketed from 18 bags to 100 bags, and she now farms four hectares.

co-lead the creation of the Global Food Security Research Strategy, convening a strategy process that engages all relevant agencies funded by the GFSA as well as major federal research funders such as the National Science Foundation, the National Institutes of Health, and others. The Global Food Security Research Strategy stipulates that “Feed the Future will support research activities that collectively represent three themes: i) climate-smart agricultural innovation, ii) nutrition and food systems, and iii) genetic improvement of crops and livestock.” These priorities emerged from Convergence Science analyses, where evidence from multiple disciplines (e.g., biophysical science, including climate science, social science, economics) are integrated to arrive at pathways that are the most likely to generate solutions to complex challenges. The research strategy is predominantly implemented through four types of research partners: National Agricultural Research Systems (NARS), consisting of local research entities in Feed the Future countries and regions; International Agricultural Research Centers (IARCs), including CGIAR; the private sector; and the Feed the Future Innovation Labs led by U.S. universities.

Feed the Future Innovation Labs

Feed the Future pairs American ingenuity and expertise with some of the best and brightest minds across the globe through its 16 Feed the Future Innovation Labs.²⁸ A unique network of more than 80 top U.S. colleges and universities across 40 states, many USDA scientists and labs, along with partner country research and educational institutions, lead implementation of Innovation Lab research investments.

USAID Helps a Women Farmers’ Cooperative through Public-Private Partnership

Nigeria faces high levels of food insecurity, with an estimated 26 million people (about 12 percent of the population) experiencing hunger due to low farm productivity, increased flooding due to climate change, soaring costs, and restricted access to food caused by violent conflict and displacement.

Led by Rabi Attah Habibu, members of the Likoro Women Farmers’ Cooperative grow maize, soybeans, and rice to feed their families and sell to others. Habibu began the group to ease hunger and malnutrition in her community. The cooperative’s success has risen through a partnership with Thrive Agric, a company providing technology and other services to aid African farmers. The West Africa Trade and Investment Hub, funded by USAID, awarded a \$1.9 million co-investment grant to Thrive Agric to support its initiative to help smallholder farmers in Nigeria. The partnership with Thrive Agric led to remarkable results. “Now we can produce the food we eat, sell, save, pay our children’s school fees, and help the community,” Habibu said. Her annual maize production skyrocketed from 18 bags to 100 bags, and she now farms four hectares.

USDA Launches International Climate Hub

USDA's International Climate Hub (ICH) conducts scientific analysis and data synthesis, creates global resources and tools, and conducts outreach to help the world's natural resource managers adapt to the impacts of climate change. Current ICH resources include its COMET-Planner Global tool, which helps the world's farmers predict the impact of certain conservation practices on GHG reductions; a library of U.S. international collaborations on agricultural climate challenges; a webinar series; and interactive tools to assess water levels, soil types, and impacts of natural disasters. ICH's 236 percent increase in readership since its inauguration in May 2023 demonstrates the need for climate change information to increase the resilience of agricultural, food, and forestry systems.

Following are updates that cover a range of Innovation Lab achievements:

The Soybean Innovation Lab's Pan-African Trials led to the registration of a new variety in Malawi and Zambia, which allowed 31 African countries to access it as a result of improved regional economic policies, where USAID policy efforts, also supported by research, are hastening access to climate-smart innovation. The new, higher-yielding seeds can more than double the yield of current farm practices and increase smallholder farm revenue fourfold. An estimated 31,000 hectares across 16 countries are demonstrating for farmers what can be achieved using market-led improvements.

The Applied Wheat Genomics Innovation Lab is building the largest public database of elite wheat varieties in the history of wheat breeding—more than 74,000 from Nepal, Bangladesh, India, and Pakistan and the International Maize and Wheat Improvement Center (CIMMYT) global wheat program. This database enables better prediction models, which will allow breeders to rapidly select climate-resilient, high-yielding varieties and put them in farmer's hands.

The Innovation Lab for Crop Improvement (ILCI) is supporting agricultural research institutions to modernize through the adoption of digital tools that improve efficiency and data sharing while fostering a more connected crop improvement ecosystem.

The Livestock Systems Innovation Lab has developed a livestock feeding support app which small dairy producers in Nepal are using to formulate rations that increase milk production by 15 percent. By improving the nutrition of their livestock, farmers can reduce feeding costs, decrease feed waste, and reduce environmental pollution.

Working with Malawi's national research system, the Peanut Innovation Lab researchers validated improved practices of smallholder farmers. Eighty-three percent of the 114,000 peanut farmers supported by USAID now apply improved technologies and practices compared to 5 percent at the outset, more than doubling net incomes.



USAID Scales Use of Technology through Space to Place

USDA's Agricultural Research Service, with support from Feed the Future research funds, is working closely with Ethiopian, Kenyan, and national partners to identify and deploy resistance to fusarium head blight of wheat. This international science team is helping solve an income, food security, and food safety challenge while also better protecting U.S. farmers, millers, bakers, and consumers for new and virulent strains of the fungus which can contaminate wheat grain and is highly toxic.

The Food Systems for Nutrition Innovation Lab undertook a census of “on the shelf” innovations and identified 265 innovations that can improve access to nutrient-dense foods. The innovations are now freely available on an interactive web platform for policymakers, technical specialists, entrepreneurs, academia, and other stakeholders working within the space of transforming food systems for nutrition.

Supporting Global Research With CGIAR

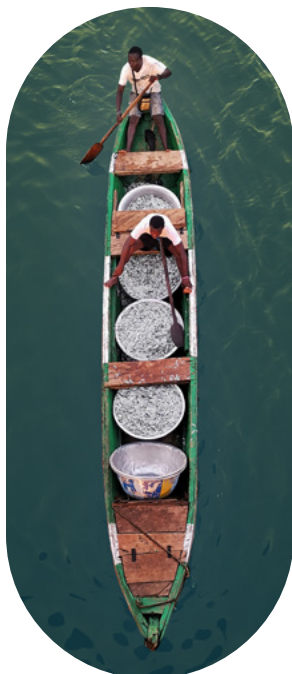
In addition to Innovation Labs, Feed the Future partners with CGIAR to conduct research on food, land, and water systems. A recent report, *The Economic Impact of CGIAR-Related Crop Technologies on Agricultural Productivity in Developing Countries*,²⁹ underscores the significant influence of CGIAR crop research. The report reveals that between 1961 and 2020, CGIAR-related crop technologies were adopted across at least 221 million hectares in Asia, Africa, and Latin America. During the 2010s, the adoption of these technologies led to an increase in economic impacts of approximately \$600 million annually, reflecting a sustained positive trend. The United States, a founding donor of CGIAR, remains a crucial supporter and leverages its resources to attract other stakeholders to participate in the CGIAR System Council, which comprises donors and host countries that review CGIAR's strategy, mission, impact, and relevance. CGIAR-related crop technologies contributed to a significant boost in crop yields, with notable improvements in the productivity of staple crops including rice and maize, which are crucial for food security in developing regions.

Africa boasts vast arable land, yet only utilizes 30 percent of its agricultural potential on current cultivated land. The Space to Place initiative aims to optimize agricultural productivity in Africa by implementing sustainable practices on existing farmland, addressing fertilizer availability, access, and soil health. By integrating geospatial data with local farming knowledge, this approach enhances fertilizer efficiency, reducing wastage by up to 80 percent and significantly boosting yields. Initially piloted in Ethiopia, this scalable initiative is set to affect four different farming areas, benefitting over 4.2 million farmers and covering 2.7 million hectares of land. With a budget of \$40 million, the initiative empowers farmers by equipping them with tailored information and tools that help increase yields, profitability, and sustainability, which benefit both farmers and the environment while empowering female farmers with critical resources.





Framing Our Renewed Ambition



Feed the Future has long articulated ambitious goals of contributing to population-level impacts that go well beyond direct participants. In this next phase of the initiative, we will strengthen our accountability and learning, where appropriate, using initiative-wide performance targets that provide measurable targets against which to assess progress and make adaptive management decisions. In addition, performance targets help communicate our priorities to external audiences, ensuring that Feed the Future investments are aligned with initiative and Agency priorities.

While we already maintain a robust monitoring and evaluation system that measures results across the initiative's objectives and programs, we have set five ambitious performance targets for FY 2030 that highlight key Feed the Future priorities and reflect critical pathways through which Feed the Future aims to drive progress on poverty, hunger, and malnutrition. These targets for FY 2030 include:

1. **Accelerated sales by farmers and firms:** The value of annual sales of producers and firms receiving assistance through Feed the Future will reach \$7 billion.
2. **Gender parity in access to finance:** Female Feed the Future participants will access \$1 of financing for every \$1 in financing accessed by male Feed the Future participants.
3. **Expanded climate adaptation:** The cultivated area under U.S. government-supported climate adaptive/climate risk management practices will increase by more than 2.7 times, reaching 7.8 million hectares.
4. **Leverage the private sector:** The value of private-sector investment leveraged by the U.S. government to support food security and nutrition will reach \$876 million.
5. **Improve women's diets:** More than half of women living in Feed the Future program areas will consume a diet of minimum diversity.

Our commitment to strengthening accountability will be complemented by our plans to increase focus and prioritization.

Feed the Future Africa Accelerator

Through detailed analysis, USAID has identified three priority countries within Feed the Future—Malawi, Tanzania, and Zambia—where USAID will increase investments to catalyze agriculture-led economic growth, transform food systems, and support a regional “breadbasket,” or agricultural corridor, to improve food and nutritional security. This increased investment aligns with the U.S.-AU Strategic Partnership on Food Security and will complement other interagency investments in these countries from the State Department, MCC, USDA, the U.S. African Development Foundation (USADF), Peace Corps, and others. In addition, the Partnership for Global Infrastructure and Investment (PGI) has committed \$600 billion from 2022–2027—much of it invested to infrastructure development in Sub-Saharan Africa. The planned development of hard infrastructure

linking Zambia with Angola through the Lobito Corridor could reduce transportation costs for Zambian agricultural products.

International Year of the Woman Farmer

Complementing the opportunities above, Feed the Future partners successfully championed the adoption of a United Nations resolution declaring 2026 as International Year of the Woman Farmer (IYWF), which will be implemented by FAO. The United States introduced the resolution calling for the IYWF, co-sponsored by 124 Member States including 12 Feed the Future target countries (Bangladesh, Democratic Republic of the Congo, Guatemala, Honduras, Kenya, Liberia, Mozambique, Nepal, Senegal, Tanzania, Uganda, and Zambia). This worldwide year of observance will call attention to the vital role that women play in global agri-food systems and catalyze action to address the persistent inequities they face while promoting women's economic empowerment in the sector—ultimately benefiting their families, communities, and societies at large through improved food security, resilience, and economic growth.

Global Leadership and Engagement

While the United States has successfully influenced much of the global dialogue around food security over the last several, tumultuous years, we have an even greater opportunity in the coming years to drive the global agenda. In 2025, we will elevate our holistic work to combat malnutrition in all its forms at the Nutrition for Growth Summit in France. The proven success, reach, and brand recognition of Feed the Future provide a strong foundation from which to build global consensus and maintain strong action in the fight against poverty, hunger, and malnutrition in the years to come.

Feed the Future looks to a future where hunger, malnutrition, and poverty do not exist. Despite setbacks over the past few years, the initiative continues to deliver impact, backed by data and evidence. As we continue to adapt to a rapidly changing global context and grapple with new budget realities, Feed the Future remains dedicated to learning and ensuring strong return on U.S. taxpayer dollars invested in ending global hunger and poverty. Continued bipartisan support will be critical to winning this battle.





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Page 7	Feed the Future Uganda Inclusive Agricultural Markets (FtF IAM) Activity. Sudipto Das. Benjamin A. Danso, AAMUSTED (Formerly UEW-Kumasi). Matt Hayes, Cornell University.
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Endnotes

- 1 FAO, IFAD, UNICEF, WFP and WHO. 2024. *The State of Food Security and Nutrition in the World 2024 – Financing to end hunger, food insecurity and malnutrition in all its forms*. Rome. <https://doi.org/10.4060/cd1254en>
- 2 <https://uscode.house.gov/view.xhtml?req=%28title:22%20section:9307%20edition:prelim%29>
- 3 Agriculture is the practice of cultivating soil, growing crops, raising livestock (including fisheries and aquaculture), and managing natural resources to produce food, fiber, and other products for human use and economic benefit.
- 4 Per the GFSS, we focus on inclusion, building resilience, and sustainability to foster policies and approaches that equitably benefit marginalized and underserved populations.
- 5 The data for output and outcome indicators above reflect results achieved among direct participants of U.S. government projects and are directly attributable to U.S. government funding. For the purposes of this report, a result is attributable to the U.S. government, or the U.S. government can claim credit for a result, even when other partners are involved in achieving the result, if they can claim that without U.S. government intervention the outcome would not have taken place. Note that while U.S. government contributions to IFAD and GAFSP support work aligned with Feed the Future goals, the U.S. government is not directive in the specific programming of these institutions.
- 6 Data were collected using the Feed the Future Indicator Handbook: <https://agrilinks.org/post/feed-future-indicator-handbook>
- 7 World Health Organization. *Climate Change*. October 12, 2023. <https://www.who.int/news-room/fact-sheets/detail/climate-change-and-health>



- 8 The PREG II impact evaluation further found that the program lifted an estimated one of every three impoverished households out of poverty as measured by an asset-based wealth index.
- 9 USAID Resilience Policy: https://www.usaid.gov/sites/default/files/2024-06/USAID3090_USAID%20Resilience%20Policy_062524_WEB%28508c%29.pdf
- 10 <https://www.nature.com/articles/s41558-021-01000-1.epdf>
- 11 Ibid.
- 12 <https://www.aimforclimate.org/>
- 13 CGIAR is a partnership of 15 global research centers dedicated to transforming food, land, and water systems in a climate crisis. The United States was a founding partner of CGIAR.
- 14 <https://www.ifpri.org/project/covid-19-food-trade-policy-tracker/>
- 15 https://au.int/sites/default/files/newsevents/conceptnotes/43470-CN-Concept_Note_for_AFSH_Summit_19.01.2024.pdf
- 16 <https://ifdc.org/2022-annual-report/>
- 17 In FY 2024, MCC closed the Compact in Niger and transferred the remaining funds to USAID, which is completing programming.
- 18 <https://www.mcc.gov/news-and-events/release/release-101824-zambia-compact-signed/>
- 19 United States. U.S. Agency for International Development. *Bridging the Gap: Financing Africa's Agricultural Growth*. Washington, D.C.
- 20 Ibid.
- 21 A second-loss guarantee is an arrangement where a guarantor agrees to cover a second round of losses after the first round of support has been used up. The guarantor is not exposed to all the risks associated with each loan account individually.
- 22 <https://www.fao.org/sustainable-development-goals-data-portal/data/indicators/1231-global-food-losses/en>
- 23 <https://reliefweb.int/report/world/gender-inequalities-and-food-insecurity-ten-years-after-food-price-crisis-why-are-women#:~:text=offset%20any%20opportunities%20higher%20output,agricultural%20workforce%20in%20developing%20countries.>
- 24 FAO: *The Status of Women in Agrifood Systems* <https://openknowledge.fao.org/server/api/core/bitstreams/e34863d6-a08a-465e-8d65-2b38f611946d/content/status-women-agrifood-systems-2023/chapter1.html>
- 25 Ibid.
- 26 Ibid.
- 27 <https://www.usaid.gov/news-information/press-releases/sep-24-2024-united-states-increases-commitment-resilience-and-opportunities-women-food-systems>
- 28 <https://www.feedthefuture.gov/feed-the-future-innovation-labs/>
- 29 <https://www.sciencedirect.com/science/article/pii/S0305750X23003418#s0045>

Commonly Used Acronyms

ACRONYM	FULL TERM
AfDB	African Development Bank
AIM for Climate	Agriculture Innovation Mission for Climate
AsDB	Asian Development Bank
AtA	Assistant to the Administrator
AU	African Union
AUC	African Union Commission
CAADP	Comprehensive African Agricultural Development Program
CGIAR	Consultative Group on International Agricultural Research
CIMMYT	International Maize and Wheat Improvement Center
CIS	Climate Information Services
CSO	civil society organizations
CU	coordination unit
DFC	U.S. International Development Finance Corporation
EBRD	European Bank for Reconstruction and Development
EPA	U.S. Environmental Protection Agency
FAO	Food and Agriculture Organization of the United Nations
FDA	U.S. Food and Drug Administration
FLW	food loss and waste
FS4FS	Food Safety for Food Security
GAFFSP	Global Agriculture and Food Security Program
GALs	Gender Action Learning System
GFSA	Global Food Security Act
GFSS	Global Food Security Strategy
GNCP	Global Nutrition Coordination Plan
GROW	Generating Resilience and Opportunities for Women
HHS	U.S. Department of Health and Human Services
IAF	Inter-American Foundation
IDB	Inter-American Development Bank

ACRONYM	FULL TERM
IFAD	International Fund for Agricultural Development
IFI	international financial institution
IFPRI	International Food Policy Research Institute
IICA	Inter-American Institute for Cooperation on Agriculture
ILs	Feed the Future Innovation Labs
IMF	International Monetary Fund
ITA	International Trade Administration
IYWF	International Year of the Woman Farmer
MEL	monitoring, evaluation, and learning
MOCCA	Maximizing Opportunities in Coffee & Cacao in the Americas
MCC	Millennium Challenge Corporation
MDB	multilateral development banks
MSMEs	micro, small, and medium enterprises
NOAA	National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration
OIG	Office of the Inspector General
PCVs	Peace Corps Volunteers
PGI	Partnership for Global Infrastructure and Investment
REFS	USAID Bureau for Resilience, Environment, and Food Security
SMEs	small- and medium-sized enterprises
SPS	sanitary and phytosanitary
USADF	U.S. African Development Foundation
USAID	U.S. Agency for International Development
USDA	U.S. Department of Agriculture
USGS	U.S. Geological Survey
USTR	Office of the U.S. Trade Representative
VACS	Vision for Adapted Crops and Soils
WFP	World Food Programme
WBG	World Bank Group
WTO	World Trade Organization
ZOI	Zone of Influence





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